
Section 14.4 Living the Sikh life

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — kachera, kangha, kara, kesh, kirpan, kurahit, Nishan Sahib, pagri, panj kakke, Rahit Maryada, sewa, vand chhakna

- The value and importance of the Rahit Maryada as guidance in Sikh daily living.
- The importance of sewa for Sikh living.
- The meaning and importance of Sikh birth rituals.
- The meaning and importance of Sikh death rituals.
- The meaning and importance of the panj kakke.
- The implications of the panj kakke for Sikhs living in the UK.
- The meaning and importance of the Nishan Sahib.
- How and why some Sikhs are involved in working for social and community cohesion.
- How one Sikh organisation helps to relieve poverty and/or suffering in the UK.
- The reasons why the organisation does this work (Sikh teachings on charity and the relief of suffering).
- Different attitudes as to whether it is easy or difficult to live the Sikh life today.

Unit 15 Buddhism

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the nature of Buddhism and its effects on the lives of Buddhist believers in the UK. There are four sections covering beliefs and values, community and tradition, worship and celebration, and living the Buddhist life.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.